A very detailed profile of Justice Minister Yariv Levin in *Haaretz* comes to the conclusion that, notwithstanding all the denials, he now seeks the first place in the Likud and thereafter to replace Netanyahu as prime minister. In the article he is called “the snake with glasses”; he is a poisonous snake with glasses.

Saturday, May 6

This evening, the eighteenth week of demonstrations against the judicial overhaul. We shall see whether Netanyahu’s implicit plan to postpone the final push for a few months, to give some time for compromise negotiations and then to evaluate the public’s attitude while lowering its desire for demonstrations, will work. It would ultimately be a victory for Yariv Levin and the various architects of the overhaul, both nationalists and Orthodox. It would certainly be the end of democracy in Israel.

The truth is that the decisive step for the end of democracy came with the decision to prolongate sine die the occupation of the West Bank and to begin the settlements. It is not at all clear whether that is reversible. Can a courageous decision for a two-state solution still be feasible to save Israeli democracy? Each day that goes by without a solution is one more day in which the hope for a true democracy fades. In the meantime, the pervasive surveillance of the Arabs gets more technologically intricate by the day: according to news outlets, face recognition cameras are now the name of the game; they are supposedly everywhere that Arabs live.

I don’t know of an obvious period of democracy before the fateful Six-Day War and the conquests that followed. Before that, all levers of the administration, the army, and the police—and, of course, all major political decisions—were in the hands of Mapai (Party of the Workers of Eretz Israel), the majority party in the iron hands of Ben-Gurion, with the brief Moshe Sharett interlude (of the same party) and the somewhat more liberal